Soft Condensed Matter: An Introduction (2026)

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Web version

The subject notes are shared across course years. This page records the 2026 teaching sequence and assessment.

Wednesdays, 10:00–11:00, PH132.

Teaching sequence

- **21 October:** Different Faces of Soft Condensed Matter.
- **28 October:** Viscosity and the start of conservation laws.
- **4 November:** finish conservation laws, then instabilities.
- **11 November:** singularities and the assessment brief.
- **18 November:** singularities in free-surface flows.
- **25 November:** viscoelasticity.
- **2 December:** sheets, bubbles and drops.
- **9 December:** project presentations and defence.

Slides

21 October: Different Faces of Soft Condensed Matter

Slides
PDF *32 MB* · PowerPoint *146 MB* · Keynote *160 MB*

Assessment

Choose one of two coding projects: a moving contact line or van der Waals film rupture. The code submission contributes 40% and the final presentation and defence contribute 60%. AI use is encouraged and must be documented in an AI log.

The 2026 course repository contains the full brief, submission dates and pull-request instructions. It replaces the paper-led presentations used in 2025.